

Worried about AI killing jobs? I have a solution: 300 million new jobs, reduced carbon, and a return to nature

Posted by u/PensiveDemon • • 0 points • 28 comments

Everyone's panicking about AI and automation making human labor obsolete...

But what if the problem isn't too few jobs... What if it's too much efficiency?

Here's my modest proposal: Let's ban tractors, outlaw industrial agriculture, and return to manual, organic farming. Seriously.

We could easily create hundreds of millions of new jobs. Imagine the workforce hand plowing fields, weeding by hand, harvesting crops under the sun. No diesel emissions. No chemical fertilizers. No AI bots in cornfields...

We'd feed ourselves the old-fashioned way, connect with the land, reduce CO2 emissions, and never worry about "bullshit jobs" again. Tech bros get to keep their AGI; we'll take the oxen.

Think of the carbon savings... Think of the calluses. Think of the spiritual rebirth of a society that actually touches dirt again.

Who's in?

Comments

u/waxpundit • 1 points • 2025-07-31 17:23 UTC

Look up the origins of the phrase "modest proposal" and it's pretty clear this is sarcastic. It's all too eloquent and subversive to be coincidence. I agree you can never be certain but in some cases you can be very sure and to me this reads as one of those cases.

u/superminingbros • 1 points • 2025-07-31 12:48 UTC

![gif](giphy|2XskdWuNUyqElkKe4bm)

u/Presidential_Rapist • 1 points • 2025-07-31 12:33 UTC

I don't really see much real panic. I just see click bait and people having stupid conversations on the Internet. There appears to be no significant threat to jobs or decline the jobs for now or seemingly in any immediate future.

I would say that AI has to improve significantly still, and robotics are a couple decades behind any big automation of labor happening.

The other thing to point out is that you said automate labor and that means you need a robots and the robots currently suck and nobody in the right mind thinks janky robots that can barely move past obstacles without falling over or about to take labor jobs.

AI and robotics are more like toys right now, they do not represent a serious threat to employment. You probably won't even run into an employment threat from automation in your entire working lifespan.

AI has another detonator two before it stops hallucinating and ideally gets its power usage down. Robotics has a couple decades to get a lot more dexterity and probably improve. It's batteries/energy density. And on top of that, it takes decades for companies to truly adopt this technology even once it's come out because the AI still has to be trained for every industry specific job. The AI and robots are never going to just come out the gate able to do jobs so that The programmers had no idea how to do. The AI can't just par the Internet and understand how to do a job. It has to be put in the real world situation with real world experts, guiding it in the exact role you needed to do. So every major industry still needs to get a hold of AI or AI and robotics and then train it likely over the course of several years until it's good enough to do the job and not screw up..

So you have decades of innovation left just to improve them automation tech and then you have decades of adoption after that.

u/BitingArtist • 1 points • 2025-07-31 12:27 UTC

We will return to feudalism. We're more than half way there. The rich will own everything, and we will serve them.

u/OkAdhesiveness5537 • 1 points • 2025-07-31 12:24 UTC

If we'd eventually automate the farming with bare metal organic ai made with copper wire tubing and thinking hardware instead of software im in 🤔

u/clopticrp • 1 points • 2025-07-31 12:22 UTC

For real nobody is looking at this the right way.

We have lots of really old infrastructure.

AI automates all the normal jobs and then people who need work are employed to retrofit the nation.

Fixed.

u/jbinsc • 1 points • 2025-07-31 12:19 UTC

You have never worked on a farm...

u/burimo • 1 points • 2025-07-31 12:15 UTC

And now sell this idea to world economic drivers: governments and corporations. They will like it, I'm sure

u/iRebelID • 1 points • 2025-07-31 12:11 UTC

We couldn't feed the population without modern farming methods

u/Alternative-Low-691 • 1 points • 2025-07-31 12:10 UTC

We should not decrease productivity, and, in general, drastic solutions are not the answer we are looking for.

Im the limit, you could propose a job where 150 million people spend every other day digging a hole and other 150 million people spend every other day filling it again, and pay everyone (productivity = zero).

u/Jonoczall • 3 points • 2025-07-31 12:09 UTC

<https://preview.redd.it/4jsrhm9pa7gf1.jpeg?width=1284&format=pjpg&auto=webp&s=7cc6bf32e6a42c90721ae53ef158b1e54d8e9b38>

Sorry, my ancestors said no.

u/Miserable-Lawyer-233 • 0 points • 2025-07-31 12:04 UTC

You're going backwards, man. That's not the answer.

u/Autobahn97 • 2 points • 2025-07-31 12:02 UTC

The younger generation doesn't want to do any real work let alone physical work that is generally shunned. This generation wants a shortcut or hack for everything and AI is the perfect shortcut which allows them to spend more time with their beloved small glowing screens.

u/Moo202 • 2 points • 2025-07-31 12:00 UTC

Bro a potato would cost \$50

u/Equivalent-Cut-9253 • 2 points • 2025-07-31 12:00 UTC

Cultural revolution type vibes

u/PensiveDemon • 4 points • 2025-07-31 11:59 UTC

Let's be real. The post is clearly sarcastic. It's pointing out the hypocrisy: people don't actually want "jobs" in the abstract. They want comfortable, modern, cushy, well-paying jobs.

If the goal were simply full employment, we'd all be digging ditches with spoons by now.

u/OXJY • 2 points • 2025-07-31 12:25 UTC

As much as I found those AI doom posts are annoying, I think you missed the point

People want to have resources to live and strive. Work and jobs are created for resource exchange.

Your proposal (I know you are joking) and many other doom posts simply remove the point of having a job for the sake of employment.

u/PensiveDemon • 0 points • 2025-07-31 13:28 UTC

Yeah, people want to have resources to live and thrive. I think unfortunately they don't stop there... No matter how much people have, they always want a little more...

And that greed creates many problems in the world.

u/AppropriateScience71 • 2 points • 2025-07-31 12:15 UTC

That's a really weak point.

Yes, of course people don't want meaningless, backbreaking jobs that do the same work as a tractor. Well, unless it pays \$50+/hour.

And full employment has never been the goal of anything, so I don't know what you're talking about.

u/IndividualMap7386 • 3 points • 2025-07-31 12:09 UTC

So maybe use a /s in a text based post. It's not "clearly sarcastic" at all. Seems very serious considering all the doom posts and this proposed solution.

u/waxpundit • 0 points • 2025-07-31 12:17 UTC

It's so obviously sarcastic, in both tone and contents. I find it fascinating someone could read this whole thing and not clock that.

u/IndividualMap7386 • 2 points • 2025-07-31 15:12 UTC

Welcome to text based forums.

That's why emojis are a thing "/s" is a thing etc.

Some more obvious than others. Given the doom state of most these subreddits, I've seen unironic posts of people wanting to go off the grid all the time. I don't know OP or how batshit crazy there are or are not. Their proposal is stupid and I hope it's sarcastic but no way to know for sure unless tagged humor or indicated.

u/waxpundit • 0 points • 2025-07-31 17:24 UTC

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u/joelpt • 6 points • 2025-07-31 12:09 UTC

Tbh it wasn't obviously sarcastic until you said this. Source: dozens of other posts on Reddit that seriously advise this

u/toliveinthisworld • 1 points • 2025-07-31 11:59 UTC

The world can't feed 8 billion people without industrial agriculture, let alone the 10 billion we'll likely peak at. As much as people hate on The Population Bomb, it was indeed true that the world was fast outstripping its capacity to feed itself before the green revolution (and that was even with industrial agriculture and fertilizer use already being widespread in the west). Some things only go in one direction, or at least are extremely hard to reverse.